PP-T-791L
February 1, 1984
SUPERSEDING
PP-T-791K
April 5, 1973

# FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

# TURKEYS AND TURKEY PARTS, READY-TO-COOK, CHILLED AND FROZEN

This specification is approved by the U.S. Department of Agriculture for use by all Federal agencies.

## 1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers ready-to-cook, chilled and frozen, whole turkeys and turkey parts, for use by all Federal agencies. The procuring agency shall specify the following, as applicable, based on the options listed herein:

- Types
- Classes
- Styles
- Basting options
- Necks and giblets options
- Weight ranges of carcasses (Note: Indicate whether net weight does or does not include necks and giblets, or basting ingredients.)
- U.S. Grades
- Packaging and packing requirements
- Marking and labeling requirements (including shipping container markings)
- Offer unit sizes

1.2 Classification. The turkeys shall be of the following types, classes, styles, basting options, necks and giblets options, weight ranges, and grades as specified.

FSC 8905

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Types

Type I - Fresh Chilled

Type II - Frozen

Classes

Class 1 - Fryer-Roaster

Class 2 - Young (sex designation may be specified)

Class 3 - Yearling (sex designation may be specified)

Styles

Style 1 - Whole, Ready-to-Cook

Style 2 - Parts, Ready-to-Cook

Basting options

° Basted

° Nonbasted

Necks and giblets options

° With necks and giblets

° Without necks and giblets

Weight ranges, as specified

U.S. Grades

° U.S. Grade A

° U.S. Grade B

° U.S. Procurement Grade I (applicable only to Style 1)

## 2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government publications. The edition of the following documents in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposals form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Federal Specifications

PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard
PPP-B-1163 - Box, Corrugated Fiberboard, High Compression Strength, Weather-Resistant, Wax-Resin Impregrated

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal specifications, standards, and Commercial Item Descriptions as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Commercial Item Descriptions. The Index, which includes cumulative bimonthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification, other Federal specifications, and Commercial Item Descriptions required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available free from General Services Administration Business Service Centers in Boston, MA; New York, NY; Philadelphia, PA; Washington, DC; Atlanta, GA; Chicago, IL; Kansas City, MO; Fort Worth, TX; Houston, TX; Denver, CO; San Francisco, CA; Los Angeles, CA; and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal product descriptions and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standard

MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage

(Copies of military specifications and standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

U.S. Department of Health and Human Services

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

(The Code of Federal Regulations and the Federal Register are for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402. When indicated, reprints of certain regulations may be obtained from the Federal agency responsible for issuance thereof.)

U.S. Department of Agriculture

U.S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers (7 CFR Part 42)



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Market Research and Development Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, South Building, 14th and Independence Avenue, SW, Washington, DC 20250.)

Regulations Governing the Voluntary Grading of Poultry Products and Rabbit Products and U.S. Classes, Standards, and Grades (7 CFR Part 70)

(Single copies may be obtained from the Poultry Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, South Building, 14th and Independence Avenue, SW, Washington, DC 20250.)

Poultry Products Inspection Regulations (9 CFR Part 381)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402. NOTE: Specific concerns regarding the requirements of 9 CFR 381.169 may be directed to: Standards and Labeling Division, Food Safety and Inspection Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, South Building, 14th and Independence Avenue, SW, Washington, DC 20250.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposals shall apply:

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department, 1616 P Street, NW, Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

## 3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Basic requirements. The turkeys shall have been raised in the United States. Slaughtering, eviscerating, processing, chilling, and freezing shall be accomplished in establishment(s) operating under the Poultry Inspection



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Program of the Food Safety and Inspection Service (FSIS), and the Poultry Grading Program of the Agricultural Marketing Service (AMS), U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA).

Slaughtering, eviscerating, processing, chilling, and freezing shall be accomplished subsequent to the date of contract unless otherwise specified in the procurement data.

There shall be no clips, tags, or bands attached to the carcasses or parts. (NOTE: This restriction does not apply to any device(s) approved by FSIS for styling the product, for example, hock locks.)

Temperatures of the products, unless specified, shall be in accordance with 9 CFR 381 throughout all operations including processing, chilling, holding, packaging, packing, freezing, and transporting between plants.

All products shall be in good condition at time of shipment. All frozen products (after being frozen, at time of shipment, and during transportation) shall be held at an environmental temperature of not higher than 0°F (-18°C), except that during loading the product may not exceed 10°F (-12°C).

Frozen turkeys shall be a uniform light and bright color. Moisture (ice) present shall not exceed occasional small areas showing a thin layer of clear or pinkish colored ice.

3.2 Tolerances. The number of necks and giblet components (heart, liver, and gizzard) shall not exceed the number of whole carcasses or the equivalent in the shipping container.

NOTE: Any of the individual giblet components or the necks may number fewer than the maximum allowed or may be missing entirely.

3.3 Types.

Type I - Fresh Chilled. Chilling of the product shall comply with the requirements of 9 CFR 381. The product shall be delivered to destination at an internal temperature of not higher than 40°F (4°C) and not lower than 28°F (-2°C). Destination temperature will be taken in the breast or thigh in the bulk of the meat.

Type II - Frozen. The placing of the chilled carcasses or parts into the freezer shall be accomplished within 48 hours after initial chilling. During this period, if not immediately placed in the freezer after chilling and packaging, the product shall be held at 36°F (2°C) or lower. The turkeys shall be frozen in compliance with 9 CFR 381 [temperature lowered to 0°F (-18°C) or lower within 72 hours].

3.4 Classes.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Class 1 - Fryer-roaster. This is a young immature turkey (usually under 16 weeks of age), of either sex, that is tender-meated with soft, pliable, smooth-textured skin and flexible breastbone cartilage.

Class 2 - Young. This is a turkey (usually under 8 months of age), that is tender-meated with soft, pliable, smooth-textured skin and breastbone cartilage that may be somewhat less flexible than that of a fryer-roaster turkey. The turkey may be of either sex, and sex designation is optional.

Class 3 - Yearling. This is a fully mature turkey (usually under 15 months of age) that is resonably tender-meated and with reasonably-textured skin. The turkey may be of either sex, and sex designation is optional.

3.5 Styles. Individual carcasses and parts of ready-to-cook turkeys shall conform to definitions and standards found in 9 CFR 381 and 7 CFR 70, except where otherwise noted in this document.

The neck shall be separated at its junction with the body. The separation of the wings and thighs from the carcass and separation of the drumsticks from the thighs shall be accomplished at the joints. All cuts shall be in a neat manner without mutilation of adjacent muscle and bone and without producing bone splinters. The cuts may be made using any mechanical means, provided the cuts are proper or as described in this document.

Style 1 - Whole, Ready-to-Cook.

Style 2 - Parts, Ready-to-Cook. Parts or portions may be cut in any manner provided they are specified in the contract or announcement and correctly labeled (i.e., thighs, drumsticks, wings, legs, breasts with ribs, legs with pelvic bone, breast quarters without wings).

3.6 Basting options.

° Basted. When the procurement data specifies basting, the injection of basting ingredients shall be in accordance with the requirements of 9 CFR 381.169. The basting solution, ingredients, and amount of solution and ingredients shall be approved by the Standards and Labeling Division, FSIS, USDA.

° Nonbasted. No solution or ingredients shall be added.

3.7 Necks and giblets.

° With necks and giblets. The necks and giblets shall be placed together in accordance with commonly accepted commercial practice and 9 CFR 381, or as specified in the procurement data.

° Without necks and giblets. Self-explanatory.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.8 Weight ranges. The procuring data shall include the weight range for whole, ready-to-cook carcasses. For turkey parts, the weight range of the carcass from which the parts are derived or the weight range of the specific parts shall be included in the procuring data. The data shall state whether the net weight does or does not include necks and giblets or basting ingredients.

Separate weight requirements for individual shipping containers or smaller units may also be specified provided those are considered acceptable in current commercial practice.

3.9 U.S. Grades. Grading shall be performed under the supervision of a USDA grader in accordance with standards of quality set forth in 7 CFR 70.

## 4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Contractor shall assure compliance with all requirements of this specification. Examination and certification by USDA, AMS agent(s) shall not relieve Contractor of his/her obligation and responsibility to deliver a product which complies with all requirements of this specification. Contractor shall assure product compliance prior to submission to the Federal Government for acceptance. Assurance of product compliance shall include an official USDA Poultry Products Grading Certificate.

4.2 Examination and supervision. Inspection for contract compliance shall be made by USDA, in accordance with 7 CFR 70, 9 CFR 381, and this specification, at the site of manufacture, both during and after processing and packaging. The procuring agency or a duly authorized representative may inspect the product at any suitable point in transit, and after delivery to point of destination. Samples taken at any point for compliance purposes shall be furnished without cost to the Federal Government. Inspection records shall be complete and made available to the Federal Government, as requested, to assure contract compliance. The passing as satisfactory of any detail of processing or materials shall not relieve Contractor of responsibility for faulty workmanship or defective materials which may be discovered at any time prior to final acceptance.

Contractor shall be liable for losses due to deterioration or spoilage which are discovered within 6 months of date of delivery to the receiving agency and which are due to Contractor's mishandling.

4.3 Examination of shipping containers. Examination of containers for condition and for labeling and markings shall be performed in accordance with the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

## 5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging and packing. The Federal Government maintains the right to verify, using appropriate test procedures, that packaging and packing materials comply with the requirements specified herein.

All packaging and packing materials shall be new, shall not impart objectionable odors or flavors to the product, and shall be approved for use in contact with food products.

Except for film bags that are exhausted or vacuumized and shrunk, plastic-film bags may be closed by sealing, tying, or folding or tucking and rolling, or a combination of these methods, provided a satisfactory seal is obtained. Metal wire ties or staples shall not be used for sealing plastic-film bags.

Containers shall be acceptable by common or other carriers for safe transportation to point of destination specified in the contract and shall be of a size to accommodate the product without slack filling or bulging.

Closure of the shipping containers shall be secure and made with commercially acceptable filament-reinforced tape, adhesive, or other similar types of materials that are applicable for cold temperature storage conditions and that provide for safe handling of the food product. Staples may be used on bottom flaps, provided the staples are fastened into the container and tightly clenched to eliminate sharp edges prior to packing the product in the container. Staples shall not be used to close the top of the container. Steel or wire straps shall not be used for closing, unless specifically required by the procurement data for special types of packing.

Packaging and packing should be in accordance with current commercial practices that are commercially acceptable for consumer- or institutional-type packaging and packing. If special packaging and packing are required, the procurement data shall so specify.

Examples of institutional-type packaging and packing are as follows:

Fresh Chilled (Ready-to-Cook, Whole). Each whole turkey may be packaged in a plastic-film bag, which will not tear or split during handling and storage of the product, then closed and packed in a fiberboard shipping container. The bags need not be shrunk or vacuumized. Alternately, the whole turkey may be packaged in a fiberboard shipping container completely lined with a plastic-film bag, by placing it open in the container and packing turkeys therein and securely closing the bag.

Frozen (Ready-to-Cook, Whole). The turkeys may be individually packaged in heat-shrinkable plastic-film bags having good oxygen and moisture barrier, tensile and bursting strength, and stability to frozen storage. (Examples



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

of films: copolymer of polyvinylidene chloride-vinyl chloride, or polyolefins.) The air shall be exhausted or vacuumized from the bag, and the bag sealed and shrunk so it snugly adheres to the turkey. Packaged turkeys may be packed into fiberboard shipping containers according to normal commercial practice for the weight range for institutional-type pack (usually four hen turkeys or two tom turkeys).

5.2 Marking and labeling. Shipping containers shall be marked and labeled as prescribed in the applicable contract or solicitation document(s).

The marking and labeling of the product shall be in accordance with the requirements of 9 CFR 381. The labels shall be approved by the Standards and Labeling Division, FSIS, USDA, prior to use [9 CFR 381.134(a)].

Basting. When the basting option is used, each bag, overwrap, or immediate-package shall be labeled prominently and appropriately with a qualifying statement so the product name is readily clarified as having added ingredients, and labeled with the kind of ingredients and a statement adequate to inform of the amount and manner of the addition of the ingredients (9 CFR 381.169). This labeling shall be approved by the Standards and Labeling Division, FSIS, USDA, prior to use.

This labeling information may be applied on the individual bag, overwrap, or immediate package, or on a printed paper insert approved for contact with food in each bag or under each overwrap, provided the information is clear and readable through the plastic-film.

Product without added basting ingredients shall not be identified as such.

5.3 For Department of Defense (DOD) procurement only. Copies of documents required by manufacturers in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting officer.

5.3.1 Examination of shipping containers. When shipping containers are required to be in accordance with PPP-B-636 or PPP-B-1163, compliance of construction and reinforcement shall be based on a certificate of conformance from the container manufacturer or, when requested, samples submitted to DOD for testing and verification. In addition, the following defects shall be classified as follows:

Major:

(1) National stock number, item description, contract number, or date of pack markings missing, incorrect, or illegible.

(2) Net weight of turkeys less than marked on shipping containers.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Minor:

(1) Other required markings missing, incorrect, or illegible.

(2) When applicable, reinforcement with nonmetallic strapping or tape is not used.

5.3.2 Packaging. Frozen turkeys shall be packaged in accordance with level B or C as specified by the contracting officer.

Level B. Whole turkey. Each whole turkey shall be inserted into a plastic-film bag and the bag securely closed in accordance with commercial practice. The bag shall cling closely to the turkey as a result of shrinking, vacuumizing, or other means, or a combination of two or more of these methods. Prior to bagging the turkey, when the necks and giblets option is specified, the giblets and neck shall be wrapped or bagged in accordance with commercial practice and then be placed in the body or neck cavity of the turkey. At the option of the supplier, an unpackaged neck may be inserted into the body or neck cavity along with the wrapped giblets.

Level C. Frozen turkeys shall be packaged in accordance with the applicable requirements of 5.1.

5.3.3 Packing. Frozen turkeys shall be packed in accordance with level B or C as specified by the contracting officer.

Level B. Not more than 60 pounds of turkeys of one description only shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box constructed, closed, and reinforced in accordance with style FTC, grade W5c or W5s of PPP-B-636. Alternatively, the shipping container shall be a snug-fitting, wax-impregnated fiberboard box constructed in accordance with style RSC, class I, type SWCFI, grade 200 of PPP-B-1163. Closure shall be with hot melt adhesive in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. The wax-impregnated box shall be reinforced with one lengthwise band and two girthwise bands in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. Reinforcement shall be restricted to nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive filament-reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. All reinforcing bands shall be uncolored or of a color which contrasts with black.

Level C. Not more than 60 pounds of turkeys of one description only shall be packed in a shipping container complying with Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable, except metal fasteners shall not be used in the final closure of the fiberboard boxes.

5.3.4 Labeling and marking.

The following information, if applicable, shall be printed or stenciled on



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

top of the shipping container near the back side in bold letters between 1 and 1-1/2 inches high, all letters being the same height:

PERISHABLE - KEEP FROZEN
0°F (-18°C) OR BELOW

(OR)

PERISHABLE - KEEP REFRIGERATED
28°F (-2°C) TO 40°F (4°C)

Labeling of interior bags. Commercial labeling of interior bags, including net weight of bagged turkey, is acceptable.

Marking of shipping containers. Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. The item description may be abbreviated and shall consist of the grade, product, class, and style of the packed turkeys. Precautionary markings for frozen perishable subsistence are applicable.

6. NOTES (See data referenced under section 1, Scope and Classification).

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Military Coordinating Activity

Army - GL

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review Activities

Army - MD, TS
Navy - MC, MS
DP - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
HHS - FDA, NIH
USDA - MRD
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

USDA - PY

Orders for this publication are to be placed with General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.